# Competitor watch · Q3 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

## Peer comparison: listed companies

| Company | Report | Revenue | Reported | Organic | Margin | Change | Margin measure |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Aalberts** | **Q3 2026 trading update** | **823.3 EUR** | **+6.6%** | **+13.0%** | **13.8%** | **+130 bps** | **EBITA margin** |
| IMI | Q3 2026 trading update | – | +3.0% | +2.0% | – | | Adj. operating margin |
| Belimo | no report for this period | | | | | | |
| Xylem | Q3 2026 results | 2,201 USD | −3.0% | 0.0% | 23.9% | +70 bps | Adj. EBITDA margin |
| Ecolab | Q3 2026 results | 4,695 USD | +12.7% | +7.0% | 19.6% | +70 bps | Organic operating margin |
| Watts | *Q3 2026 results — due 4 Nov 2026* | | | | | | |
| Emerson[1] | Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026) | 4,873 USD | +7.0% | +6.0% | 28.5% | +140 bps | Adj. segment EBITA margin |
| Pentair | Q3 2026 results | 976.0 USD | −4.5% | −5.0% | 24.8% | −90 bps | Adj. return on sales |
| Georg Fischer | no report for this period | | | | | | |
| Danfoss[2] | no report for this period | | | | | | |

## Organic growth by quarter

| Company | Q1 2025 | Q2 2025 | Q3 2025 | FY 2025 | Q1 2026 | Q2 2026 | Q3 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Aalberts** | **−3.3%** | **−3.2%** | **−1.9%** | **−2.5%** | **+2.8%** | **+5.0%** | **+13.0%** |
| IMI | −3.0% | +2.0% | +12.0% | +5.0% | +5.0% | +5.0% | +2.0% |
| Belimo | – | +20.6% | – | +23.3% | – | +29.6% | – |
| Xylem | +3.0% | +6.0% | +7.0% | +5.0% | 0.0% | +1.0% | 0.0% |
| Ecolab | +3.0% | +3.0% | +3.0% | +3.0% | +4.0% | +5.0% | +7.0% |
| Watts | −2.1% | +5.8% | +9.4% | +5.3% | +11.9% | +12.2% | due |
| Emerson[1] | +2.0% | +2.0% | +3.0% | +3.0% | +2.0% | +0.5% | +6.0% |
| Pentair | −0.8% | +1.3% | +3.3% | – | +1.1% | −17.3% | −5.0% |
| Georg Fischer | – | +0.1% | – | −1.7% | – | +5.7% | – |
| Danfoss[2] | – | −3.0% | – | +3.0% | – | +15.0% | – |

**Notes:** organic growth as each company defines it. Green / red = growth / decline. The outlined column is Q3 2026.

## Reported margin by quarter

| Company | Q1 2025 | Q2 2025 | Q3 2025 | FY 2025 | Q1 2026 | Q2 2026 | Q3 2026 | Margin measure |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Aalberts** | **13.6%** −60 bps | **13.5%** −150 bps | **12.5%** −120 bps | **13.2%** −180 bps | **14.2%** +60 bps | **14.4%** +90 bps | **13.8%** +130 bps | **EBITA margin** |
| IMI | – | 18.2% +30 bps | – | 20.0% +30 bps | – | 18.7% +50 bps | – | Adj. operating margin |
| Belimo | – | 22.8% +320 bps | – | 20.8% +159 bps | – | 22.5% −30 bps | – | EBIT margin |
| Xylem | 20.4% +120 bps | 21.8% +100 bps | 23.2% +200 bps | 22.2% +160 bps | 20.6% +20 bps | 23.3% +150 bps | 23.9% +70 bps | Adj. EBITDA margin |
| Ecolab | 16.0% +190 bps | 18.3% +170 bps | 18.7% +110 bps | 17.9% +150 bps | 16.7% +70 bps | 18.8% +40 bps | 19.6% +70 bps | Organic operating margin |
| Watts | 19.0% | 21.6% | 18.5% +140 bps | 19.6% +190 bps | 20.1% +110 bps | 21.0% −60 bps | due | Adj. operating margin |
| Emerson[1] | 28.0% +340 bps | 28.0% +200 bps | 27.1% 0 bps | 27.6% +160 bps | 27.7% −30 bps | 27.6% −40 bps | 28.5% +140 bps | Adj. segment EBITA margin |
| Pentair | 24.0% | 26.4% | 25.7% | – | 25.0% +100 bps | 25.4% −100 bps | 24.8% −90 bps | Adj. return on sales |
| Georg Fischer | – | 10.4% −130 bps | – | 11.4% −150 bps | – | 13.4% | – | Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions |
| Danfoss[2] | – | 10.6% −90 bps | – | 12.9% +40 bps | – | 15.3% +350 bps | – | Operational EBITA margin |

**Notes:** each company's own margin measure (last column), so levels are not like-for-like. Change versus the same period last year in bps; green / red = margin up / down. The outlined column is Q3 2026.

**Notes:** [1] Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them. [2] Danfoss is not listed on a stock exchange (owned by the Danfoss family and the Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation), so it has no share price; it is included because it publishes audited financial results, half-year and full-year only.

# Key messages: listed companies · Q3 2026

Executive summary of the main messages per company, in three clusters.

## 1. Overall performance

- **Aalberts**: revenue **823.3** EUR m (+6.6%), organic **+13.0%**, EBITA margin **13.8%** +130 bps. All three segments improved organic growth and EBITA margin; added value margin remained at a good level.
- **IMI**: organic **+2.0%**. Process Automation orders +19% organic in Q3 (+14% YTD; new construction +27%, aftermarket +7%); revenue −6% on shipment timing.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): Sales CHF 676.4m, +20.5% in CHF and +29.6% in local currencies; data centres delivered a bit more than half of the absolute growth.
- **Xylem**: revenue **2,201** USD m (−3.0%), organic **0.0%**, Adj. EBITDA margin **23.9%** +70 bps. Orders USD 2,331m, +10% organic, book-to-bill >1; backlog USD 5.5bn (+16% organic).
- **Ecolab**: revenue **4,695** USD m (+12.7%), organic **+7.0%**, Organic operating margin **19.6%** +70 bps. Organic operating margin 19.6% (+70 bps); adjusted operating income +14%.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Record sales USD 763m, +19% reported and +12% organic; adj. EPS $3.66 (+18%), above consensus (~$3.33).
- **Emerson**[1]: revenue **4,873** USD m (+7.0%), organic **+6.0%**, Adj. segment EBITA margin **28.5%** +140 bps. Adj. segment EBITA margin 28.5% (+140 bps); adj. EPS $1.71 (+13%), above guidance.
- **Pentair**: revenue **976.0** USD m (−4.5%), organic **−5.0%**, Adj. return on sales **24.8%** −90 bps. Adj. operating income USD 242m (−8%), adj. return on sales 24.8%.
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Now a pure-play Flow Solutions group: Flow Solutions sales CHF 1,584m, +5.1% (+5.7% organic).
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Sales EUR 5,254m (4,703m), organic +15% led by North America and Asia (China, India); all three segments grew with strong order intake.

## 2. M&A moves

- **Aalberts**: GVT post-merger integration (semicon) completed.
- **IMI**: Agreed acquisition of iSMA CONTROLLI (Oct 2026): a bolt-on in smart-connected building controls for small and medium-sized commercial buildings.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): No acquisitions or disposals found for 2026; growth is organic, backed by capacity investment.
- **Xylem**: Acquisitions of Cornell & Roper (expected Q4 2026) and WaterFleet (~USD 200m, signed in Q2) to rotate toward higher-growth markets.
- **Ecolab**: CoolIT Systems (data-centre liquid cooling) closed 2 Jul 2026 for ~USD 4.75bn cash (USD 4.63bn net of cash); ~USD 550m sales expected in the first 12 months.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Acquisitions added USD 34m of revenue in Q2 (5 pts of growth)
- **Emerson**[1]: No new acquisitions or disposals announced in the quarter; portfolio focus remains on automation after the 2025 buy-out of AspenTech minorities.
- **Pentair**: Acquisition of Taco (Taco Group Holdings, HVAC hydronics) completed 1 Oct 2026: ~USD 560m sales in 2026 (+~23%), >USD 620m expected in 2027.
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Majority of GF Casting Solutions sold in February 2026
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Bought the remaining 38% of Semikron Danfoss (power semiconductors) in Q1 2026, now 100% owned.

## 3. Operations, innovation and production

- **Aalberts**: Operational excellence programmes and footprint optimisation in building and industry.
- **IMI**: £500m share buyback (£250m done by June); interim dividend +10% to 12.1p.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): Capacity: new production and logistics building in Hinwil (CH) opened Aug 2026; 170,000 sq ft warehouse in Stratford, CT
- **Xylem**: From 1 Jan 2027, four segments become three: Treatment & Services (~USD 3.5bn), Flow Solutions (~2.6bn), Measurement & Analytics (~2.1bn)
- **Ecolab**: Ecolab Digital sales +34% to USD 129m.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Data centre sales more than tripled to ~8% of H1 sales, driven by the newly launched CoolVault thermal storage tanks.
- **Emerson**[1]: ~USD 2.2bn shareholder returns planned for FY 2026, including USD 1bn of buybacks (USD 898m done by fiscal Q3).
- **Pentair**: Pool channel inventory realignment with major partners completed
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Net debt CHF 1,684m at end-2025 after the transformation
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Data centres drive growth in all three segments: air- and liquid-cooling, power conversion, energy storage and heat recovery for hyperscalers and chip makers.

**Sources:** each company's report for the period (see the dashboard's report library).

# Other key competitors · Q3 2026

Private companies and divisions, by relevance to HFC; dated public information for this period (press releases, trade press, filings).

| Company (relevance) | Performance | M&A | Operations |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Caleffi**<br>very high (5/5) | | | INTERCLIMA 2026 (Paris, 28 Sep – 1 Oct): exhibited co-branded with its long-standing French distribution partner Thermador. |
| **Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup)**<br>very high (5/5) | | | Reported 15 Jul 2026: Rimavská Sobota is reflexGroup's eighth production site, adding capacity for domestic hot water and buffer tanks; designed for ~450 employees. |
| **Grundfos**<br>high (4/5) | | Completed the acquisition of EUWA (Gärtringen, Germany; water treatment for breweries and soft drinks, installations in >110 countries), announced mid-July 2026; extends its water-treatment platform after Newterra. | WEFTEC 2026 (New Orleans, 26–30 Sep): unveiled a combined water-treatment offer bringing Newterra, MECO and Water Works under the Grundfos brand together with its own pumps. |
| **Armstrong Fluid Technology**<br>moderate (3/5) | | | Showcased HVAC and intelligent fluid-flow solutions at BEX Asia, Singapore (Sep 2026). |
| **Siemens Smart Infrastructure***<br>moderate (3/5) | Fiscal Q3 2026: orders EUR 8.0bn (+42%, record), revenue EUR 6.4bn (+13% comparable), profit EUR 1.3bn (20.0%); backlog EUR 23.7bn | | |
| **Wilo**<br>moderate (3/5) | | | Established Wilo Japan (Aug 2026), targeting data centres. |
| **Alfa Laval**<br>low (2/5) | Q3 2026: record order intake SEK 23.2bn (+33% organic), net sales SEK 18.6bn (~+6% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1% (18.4%); data-centre orders ~SEK 2bn in the quarter. | | |
| **Resideo (Honeywell Home)**<br>low (2/5) | | Completed the separation of ADI (distribution) on 3 Aug 2026; standalone Q3 guide USD 705–730m revenue | |
| **Victaulic**<br>low (2/5) | | Acquired Arumani to expand European modular construction and mechanical assemblies (Aug 2026) | |

No dated public information found for this period: Oventrop, Spirotech, ADEY, Cetetherm, ESBE, Fernox, Frese, Giacomini, HERZ Armaturen, PAW, PEWO Energietechnik, Wessels Company, Zilmet.

**Notes:** * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them.